

ISLAMIC UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY(IUT)
Organization of Islamic Cooperation(OIC)
Boand Bazar, Gazipur, Bangladesh

Department of Computer Science and Engineering(CSE)
Program : Software Engineering

COURSE TITLE: Islamiat

COURSE CODE: HUM 4145

ASSIGNMENT NO: 02

NAME OF THE ASSIGNMENT: Islamic Ethics in
My Profession - A
Personal Reflection
Report

NAME OF THE STUDENT: Waseef Munir

STUDENT ID: 240042148

DATE OF SUBMISSION: 17/03/2026

Why I Chose This Ethical Dilemma:

As a CSE student, I regularly use different types of software for my classwork, studies, projects and assignments. Students often find it difficult to afford these software, as many of them, such as Adobe Photoshop, MATLAB, AutoCAD and even operating systems like Windows are quite expensive. Because of this, I have noticed many students, even my classmates, use pirated or cracked version of softwares. This practice has become very common and is accepted as something normal to my classmates.

However, this situation made me think if using pirated software is morally acceptable, especially from an Islamic perspective. It is obvious that students need these softwares for their educational purposes, but at the same time using pirated software means using someone else's product without proper permission or payment.

I chose this dilemma because it is directly connected to my field and reflects a real issue that I may personally face in my academic and professional life. As a future software engineer and a Muslim, I believe it is important to understand if using pirated or cracked software is morally and Islamically justified. I also have to understand about how I should deal with them in a responsible way.

~~IX~~ Description of the Ethical Dilemma:

Software piracy refers to the use of software without proper permission or payment. It usually involves downloading cracked or modified versions of software from unauthorized sources. These cracked versions allow users to access full features without any cost. This practice is very common among students as many software tools are expensive and not easily affordable.

However, the use of pirated software tools creates a serious ethical dilemma. On one side, students need these software for their studies, researches, assignments, creative works and so on. It may become difficult for them to develop their skills without using these softwares. On the other hand, using pirated software means violating the rights of the developers who created this software.

Therefore, this dilemma exists between the necessity of students and ethical responsibility, which makes it an important issue to analyze from both professional and Islamic perspective.

Islamic Ethical Analysis:

(i) Halal and Haram: From an Islamic perspective, the concept of Halal - and Haram provide clear guidance on what actions are acceptable. In the case of using pirated software, I can understand that using a software without owner's consent or paying is called software pirating. A software is an intellectual property, and pirating or stealing this type of property is strictly prohibited in Islam. Allah says in the Quran,

"Do not consume one another's wealth unjustly." (Sura Al-Baqarah, 2:188)

In addition, the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said,

"Whoever cheats is not one of us".
(Muslim)

Using cracked or pirated software can be seen as a form of cheating because

it lets a user to access all paid features without any cost. Even though I have seen many people justifying this piracy due to high cost, but I also realize that difficulty does not make something Halal automatically. Therefore, according to Islamic teachings, using pirated software falls into the category of Haram.

(ii) Amanah (Trust):

Amanah or trust is a fundamental principle in Islam. As a Muslim, I believe that I am responsible for maintaining trusts in all aspects of life, including the digital world. When software companies release a product or an application, they trust users to follow the licensing rules and use the software honestly. However, using pirated software breaks this trust because it involves using the product without owner's permission. Allah commands

in the Quran not to break trust. He says in the Quran,

"Indeed, Allah commands you to render trusts to whom they are due."
(Surah Al-Nisa, 4:58)

Moreover, the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) also said,

"Return the trust to the one who trusted you."
(Abu Dawood)

This hadith reminds me that trust must not be broken under any circumstances. In terms of software piracy, using unauthorized copies of software tool breaks the trust between the developer and the user. As a future software engineer and as a Muslim, I understand that I would expect others to respect my work. Therefore, I should also respect the right of others and avoid actions that can break this trust.

(iii) Maqasid al-Shariah (Protection of Wealth):

Maqasid al-Shariah refers to the higher objectives of Islamic law, which aim to protect essential aspects of human life. One of these objective is the protection of wealth (Hifz al-Mal). Islam puts great importance on protecting ownership and ensuring that people's property is not taken unjustly. In the case of software piracy, I see that developers and companies invest time, effort, and money to create software projects. When someone uses pirated or cracked version, he is violating the financial rights of these creators. Allah says in the Quran,

"Do not use one another's property unjustly or send it in bribery to the rulers." (Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:188)

This verse from the Quran emphasizes the importance of respecting property rights.

The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) also said in the hadith,

"The property of a Muslim is not lawful for another except for his willing consent."
(Ahmad)

This hadith clearly shows that taking someone's property without permission is not allowed. Therefore, software piracy directly contradicts the Maqasid principle of protecting wealth, as it harms both individuals and organizations financially.

Real-World Impact of Software Piracy:

Software piracy has many negative impacts on individuals, companies and society as a whole. First of all, it causes financial loss to software developers and companies. These organizations invest significant amount of time, effort, and resources to develop high quality software. When people use pirated versions, the developers and companies do not receive fair payment for their work, which can reduce their motivation to improve their products. It also degrades the fame of software companies and organizations.

Secondly, piracy also creates an unethical culture among students and professionals. When piracy becomes common, people start to take it normally, while on the other hand software companies continues to face financial loss. By using pirated software, users develop a mindset to take other's work without

their permission. This type of mindset can affect future behaviour, especially for students who will become software engineers.

Another major issue is security risk. Pirated or cracked software often come up with unwanted malwares or viruses, which can lead to data theft, system damage, and privacy violations.

In Islamic viewpoint, pirating software conflicts with ethical values, as Islam discourages actions that cause injustice and harm to others. Therefore, software piracy is not only a legal issue, but also a serious moral and social problem.

✱ Islamic Solution (Halal Alternatives):

To solve the issue of software piracy, it is important to follow solutions that are both practical and Islamically acceptable. Islam encourages honesty, fairness and respect for other's rights. Therefore, instead of using pirated softwares, I believe students should look for lawful alternatives that do not violate ethical or religious principles.

(i) Use of Open-Source Software: One of the most effective solution is using open-source software, which is free and completely legal. Tools like GIMP, LibreOffice and Linux provide many useful features similar to paid software. By using these alternatives, students can complete their work without violating any ethical or Islamic principles.

(ii) Student Licenses and Educational Discounts: Many software companies offer special licenses and discounts for students. Platforms like Microsoft, Adobe, and Autodesk provide affordable or even free access for educational

purposes. By using these options, students can legally use professional tools while respecting the rights of developers and maintaining honesty in their actions.

(iii) Use of Free and Cloud-Based Tools:

Students can also use free online tools such as Canva, Figma and Google Docs. These platforms offer useful features for designing, writing, and collaboration without requiring payment. They are easy to use and accessible from anywhere. This allows students to avoid piracy while still meeting their academic needs effectively.

(iv) Promoting Ethical Awareness: It is imp-

ortant to raise awareness about the ethical and Islamic issues of software piracy. Educational institutions and students should encourage responsible use of technology. Understanding the consequences of piracy can help students make better decisions. This awareness can promote honesty, responsibility, and a more ethical digital environment in society.

Personal Reflection:

As a future software engineer and as a Muslim, the dilemma has made me reflect on my own thoughts. In the past, I did not always think deeply about whether using pirated software was ethically right or wrong. Like many students, I sometimes focused more on convenience and necessity rather than considering the ethical and Islamic aspects of my choices. However, after analyzing this issue, I have come to a realization that such actions can have serious ethical consequences.

From an Islamic perspective, I now understand that honesty, trust, and respect for others' rights are very important. As a future software engineer, I would expect others to respect my work and pay for accessing any premium features. Therefore, I should also

follow the same principle in my own life. This realization has encouraged me to be more responsible in my use of technology.

In the future, I aim to avoid using pirated software and instead choose legal and ethical alternatives. I also want to promote awareness among general people and my classmates about the importance of digital ethics. By doing so, I hope to align my professional life with Islamic values and maintain integrity in my action.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, software piracy is not only a technical or legal issue, but also an important ethical and Islamic concern. Through this discussion, I have understood that using pirated software violates the principles of honesty, trust, and protection of wealth in Islam. Even though it may seem convenient, it cannot be justified ethically and from an Islamic perspective. As a future software engineer, I believe it is my responsibility to follow ethical practices and choose Halal alternatives in both my academic and professional life.
